



Rise of AI agents in content creation

◀ Govind Balakrishnan, Senior Vice President of the Express Product Group & Digital Media Services at Adobe

Adobe's Govind Balakrishnan believes AI agents can transform the way we create and innovate

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Adobe has been re-positioning Express, its all-in-one creative platform, as a single solution for individuals and businesses alike. It got a new identity with the arrival of generative AI, and now the integration of AI agents opens more possibilities for the platform. Adobe is integrating these AI agents to assist with content creation, offering features like image generation, template suggestions, and design customisation.

These agents are ushering in an era where creativity is not just augmented by technology but radically reimagined through it.

"We now have the ability to reimagine creativity itself. You are no longer constrained by templates, your own assets, or even tool proficiency. You're only limited by your imagination," emphasised Govind Balakrishnan, Senior Vice President of the Express Product Group & Digital Media Services at Adobe.

With Adobe's AI agents embedded deeply within Express, users can now simply describe what they want to create in natural language. The agent understands the intent, builds out design elements, generates motion or

video, and presents a finished piece that users can further refine, if they choose to.

"The magic lies in the fact that you don't have to tweak anything, but you can," Balakrishnan emphasised. "The tools are still there for those who want to go deeper."

Democratizing creativity

Previously, design was limited to those with time, tools, or technical know-how. Now, with prompt-based creation and natural language interfaces, Express lets anyone design like a pro. "You don't have to know how to manipulate pixels anymore to be creative," Balakrishnan explained. "You just need to be able to express your idea."

When asked about the fine line between machine-generated output and human creativity, Balakrishnan is clear – it's not about replacement but augmentation.

"AI agents give users a head start. But at the end of the day, the power still lies with the creator," he said. "You can start with a prompt and take the machine's help, or you can dive in and tweak every detail. It's all about your own appetite and intent."

When asked about competing platforms like Canva, Balakrishnan said that one of the strongest differentia-

tors for Express, is its integration with Adobe's larger ecosystem: Creative Cloud, Acrobat, and others. This ecosystem approach means workflows are not siloed. A video edited in Premiere Pro can be quickly transformed into a social-ready clip in Express.

Even more significant is how generative AI has been built into the platform from the ground up. "It's embedded contextually within the workflow, making it feel like a natural part of the creation process," he said.

Another advantage for users is Adobe's firm stance on copyright, Balakrishnan added. "Everything created through Express's generative AI tools is safe for commercial use. Whether you're a solo creator or a large enterprise, you don't need to worry about rights issues," he said.

India in focus

Adobe's AI ambitions aren't confined to Silicon Valley. In fact, India is emerging as a strategic focus market for the Express platform. Over the past year, Adobe Express has seen a staggering 3x growth in adoption in India.

According to Balakrishnan, this momentum is being driven by three main factors (in no particular order): mobile-first access, support for local languages, and availability of culturally relevant templates. **d**

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